



Grade 4 Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 4 · FULL YEAR

~12½ hrs per week · 150 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Grade 4 Language Arts is a yearlong reading and writing course built around five core novels. Scholars read one to two chapters a day, study how authors build character, voice, and theme, and write in every genre: narrative, realistic fiction, opinion, research, and literary analysis. The first six weeks deliberately review third-grade word-part knowledge, then morphology moves into application with Greek and Latin roots, academic vocabulary, and the words scholars meet in their novels.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Mrs. Frisby and the Rats of NIMH (Weeks 1–6)

Plot, motivation, and theme; scholars draft, revise, and publish a narrative.

3 Number the Stars (Weeks 15–19)

Historical fiction with a background-knowledge bridge week; scholars publish an opinion essay about courage or loyalty.

5 Prince Caspian (Weeks 26–30)

Fantasy and leadership; scholars write literary analysis on character and theme.

2 Anne of Green Gables (Weeks 7–14)

Voice, perspective, and character change across a whole novel; scholars write and publish their own realistic fiction.

4 Freedom Train (Weeks 20–25)

The story of Harriet Tubman, read alongside primary sources; scholars research, write expository pieces, and present.

6 Year-End Synthesis (Weeks 31–32)

Scholars compare themes across the year's books and finish with a final project, presentation, or portfolio reflection.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Novel reading on a four-day cycle, about 1–2 chapters a day, with a weekly "What Good Readers Do" reading skill.
- Morphology and word analysis: prefixes, suffixes, Greek and Latin bases, syllable work, and spelling rules applied in real writing.
- Grammar distributed across the year (about 30 core skills) with spiral review, often as a short daily warm-up.
- Writing connected to the reading: narrative, realistic fiction, opinion, research, and literary analysis.

TIME COMMITMENT

750 minutes / week

≈ 2½ hours a day, Monday–Friday

- A typical day blends novel reading, word work, grammar, and writing.
- The scope and sequence plans four core ELA days each week; scheduled time also supports fluency practice, assessment, and review.
- Publishing weeks may run longer as drafts become final pieces.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A copy of each core novel (home, library, or school-provided; approved texts can vary by section).
- A reading and writing notebook, pencil, and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for typed and published writing.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.